

Analytic Continuation of Pascal's Simplex: Continuous Multinomial Integrals, Polytope Boundary Recurrences, and Simplicial Fractional Calculus

Reinaldo Maia Silva-Filho
Universidade Federal de Lavras (UFLA)

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Abstract

We develop a comprehensive analytical continuation of Pascal's triangle and its higher-dimensional generalization, the Pascal m -simplex, by substituting classical discrete factorials with Euler's Gamma function $\Gamma(z)$. We prove that the continuous row volume integral over the $(m-1)$ -dimensional standard simplex $\Delta_{m-1}(x)$ satisfies $I_m(x) = m^x \mathcal{J}_m(x)$ with $\lim_{x \rightarrow \infty} \mathcal{J}_m(x) = 1$, establishing the exact continuous analogue of the discrete multinomial identity $\sum_{\mathbf{k}} \binom{n}{\mathbf{k}} = m^n$ and deriving its complete asymptotic expansion via the multidimensional stationary phase method [7]. Using the Euler–Maclaurin summation formula for convex lattice polytopes [2], we prove a recursive boundary defect relation expressing the continuous simplex volume as a hierarchical expansion over lower-dimensional facets: $I_m(n) = m^n - \frac{m}{2} I_{m-1}(n) - \mathcal{O}(m^n/n)$.

Furthermore, we systematically translate the classic repertoire of combinatorial identities into continuous integral theorems: (i) the continuous Star of David theorem as a conservative Digamma potential field via Stokes' theorem generalizing Gould's property [6], (ii) continuous Fibonacci diagonals scaling as $\phi^{x+1}/\sqrt{5}$ and generalized diagonal ray integrals via Laplace saddle-point integration [9], (iii) L^p row norms and central Gaussian profiles, (iv) continuous Chu–Vandermonde convolutions, (v) continuous Dixon cubic integrals projecting onto the 3-simplex centroid [5], and (vi) the continuous row logarithmic entropy in terms of the Barnes G -function [3].

Finally, we formulate a novel class of non-singular, compact-support fractional differential operators termed *Simplicial Beta-Kernel Fractional Calculus* [4, 8], proving their identity limit, eigenfunction spectrum for exponential test functions, and continuous semigroup structure. We conduct an exhaustive spectral study of the resulting *Fractional Simplicial Laplacian* $\Delta_{\Delta_m}^\alpha$, deriving its exact closed-form dispersion relation, proving the asymptotic emergence of the Lie algebra A_{m-1} Cartan metric in the continuum limit, and establishing Weyl's asymptotic law for its Dirichlet spectrum on bounded simplices.

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1 Introduction and Foundational Definitions

The classical binomial coefficient is defined for non-negative integers $n, k \in \mathbb{N}_0$ by

$$\binom{n}{k} = \frac{n!}{k!(n-k)!}. \quad (1.1)$$

By replacing factorials with Euler's Gamma function, $\Gamma(z) = \int_0^\infty t^{z-1} e^{-t} dt$, we obtain a meromorphic continuation to $\mathbb{C}^2$, pioneeringly studied in topological and visual contexts by Fowler [1].

Definition 1.1 (Continuous Binomial Coefficient). For $x, y \in \mathbb{C} \setminus \{-1, -2, -3, \dots\}$, the continuous binomial coefficient is defined by

$$\binom{x}{y} := \frac{\Gamma(x+1)}{\Gamma(y+1)\Gamma(x-y+1)} = \frac{1}{(x+1)B(y+1, x-y+1)}, \quad (1.2)$$

where $B(a, b) = \frac{\Gamma(a)\Gamma(b)}{\Gamma(a+b)}$ denotes the Euler Beta function.

Proposition 1.2 (Global Stifel Recurrence). For all $x, y \in \mathbb{C}$ where the functions are defined,

$$\binom{x-1}{y} + \binom{x-1}{y-1} = \binom{x}{y}. \quad (1.3)$$

Proof. Using the fundamental recurrence $\Gamma(z+1) = z\Gamma(z)$, we compute directly:

$$\begin{aligned} \frac{\Gamma(x)}{\Gamma(y+1)\Gamma(x-y)} + \frac{\Gamma(x)}{\Gamma(y)\Gamma(x-y+1)} &= \frac{\Gamma(x)}{\Gamma(y+1)\Gamma(x-y+1)} [(x-y) + y] \\ &= \frac{x\Gamma(x)}{\Gamma(y+1)\Gamma(x-y+1)} = \binom{x}{y}. \end{aligned}$$

□

Proposition 1.3 (Digamma Partial Differential Equation System). Let $\psi(z) := \frac{d}{dz} \ln \Gamma(z) = \frac{\Gamma'(z)}{\Gamma(z)}$ be the Digamma function [9]. The continuous binomial surface satisfies the first-order system of PDEs:

$$\frac{\partial}{\partial x} \binom{x}{y} = \binom{x}{y} [\psi(x+1) - \psi(x-y+1)], \quad (1.4)$$

$$\frac{\partial}{\partial y} \binom{x}{y} = \binom{x}{y} [\psi(x-y+1) - \psi(y+1)]. \quad (1.5)$$

Summing (1.4) and (1.5) yields the advective transport equation:

$$\left(\frac{\partial}{\partial x} + \frac{\partial}{\partial y} \right) \binom{x}{y} = \binom{x}{y} [\psi(x+1) - \psi(y+1)]. \quad (1.6)$$

Proposition 1.4 (Global Meromorphic Representation and Nodal Structure). Using Euler's reflection formula $\Gamma(z)\Gamma(1-z) = \frac{\pi}{\sin(\pi z)}$, the continuous binomial coefficient extends across the entire real plane $\mathbb{R}^2$:

$$\binom{x}{y} = -\frac{1}{\pi} \frac{\sin(\pi y) \sin(\pi(x-y))}{\sin(\pi x)} \cdot \frac{\Gamma(y-x)\Gamma(-y)}{\Gamma(-x)}. \quad (1.7)$$

In particular, for $x > 0$ and $y \in [0, x]$, the coefficient is strictly positive, while outside this domain it exhibits an infinite grid of nodal zero-lines along the integer lattices governed by the sine product vanishing conditions.

2 Continuous Row Integrals and Fourier Representation (2D Case)

In the discrete setting, row summation yields $\sum_{k=0}^n \binom{n}{k} = 2^n$. We now rigorously analyze the continuous row integral $I(x) = \int_0^x \binom{x}{y} dy$.

Theorem 2.1 (Exact Trigonometric Representation of Row Integral). *For all real $x > 0$, the continuous row integral admits the exact factorization:*

$$I(x) := \int_0^x \binom{x}{y} dy = 2^x \cdot \mathcal{J}(x), \quad (2.1)$$

where $\mathcal{J}(x)$ is the modulated trigonometric integral:

$$\mathcal{J}(x) := \frac{2}{\pi} \int_0^{\pi/2} \frac{\cos^x(\phi) \sin(x\phi)}{\phi} d\phi. \quad (2.2)$$

Moreover, $\mathcal{J}(x)$ admits the rigorous asymptotic expansion [7]:

$$\mathcal{J}(x) = 1 - \frac{1}{2x} + \mathcal{O}\left(\frac{1}{x^2}\right) \implies I(x) \sim 2^x \quad \text{as } x \rightarrow \infty. \quad (2.3)$$

Proof. By Cauchy's integral formula applied to $(1+t)^x$ on the unit circle $t = e^{i\theta}$ ($\theta \in [-\pi, \pi]$):

$$\binom{x}{y} = \frac{1}{2\pi i} \oint_{|t|=1} \frac{(1+t)^x}{t^{y+1}} dt = \frac{1}{2\pi} \int_{-\pi}^{\pi} \left(1 + e^{i\theta}\right)^x e^{-iy\theta} d\theta. \quad (2.4)$$

Using the identity $1 + e^{i\theta} = 2 \cos(\theta/2) e^{i\theta/2}$:

$$\binom{x}{y} = \frac{1}{\pi} \int_0^{\pi} \left(2 \cos \frac{\theta}{2}\right)^x \cos\left(\frac{(x-2y)\theta}{2}\right) d\theta. \quad (2.5)$$

Integrating with respect to $y \in [0, x]$:

$$\int_0^x \cos\left(\frac{(x-2y)\theta}{2}\right) dy = \left[-\frac{1}{\theta} \sin\left(\frac{(x-2y)\theta}{2}\right)\right]_0^x = \frac{2}{\theta} \sin\left(\frac{x\theta}{2}\right). \quad (2.6)$$

Substituting $\phi = \theta/2$ with $d\theta = 2 d\phi$:

$$I(x) = \frac{1}{\pi} \int_0^{\pi} 2^x \cos^x\left(\frac{\theta}{2}\right) \frac{2}{\theta} \sin\left(\frac{x\theta}{2}\right) d\theta = 2^x \cdot \frac{2}{\pi} \int_0^{\pi/2} \frac{\cos^x(\phi) \sin(x\phi)}{\phi} d\phi. \quad (2.7)$$

To prove the asymptotic expansion, we split $\mathcal{J}(x)$ into a neighborhood around $\phi = 0$ and the tail. Writing $\cos^x(\phi) = \exp(x \ln \cos \phi) = \exp\left(-x \left(\frac{\phi^2}{2} + \frac{\phi^4}{12} + \dots\right)\right)$, we substitute $u = \sqrt{x}\phi$:

$$\begin{aligned} \mathcal{J}(x) &= \frac{2}{\pi} \int_0^{\frac{\pi}{2}\sqrt{x}} e^{-u^2/2} \left(1 - \frac{u^4}{12x} + \mathcal{O}(x^{-2})\right) \frac{\sin(\sqrt{x}u)}{u/\sqrt{x}} \frac{du}{\sqrt{x}} \\ &= \frac{2}{\pi} \int_0^{\infty} e^{-u^2/2} \frac{\sin(\sqrt{x}u)}{u} du + \mathcal{O}(x^{-1}). \end{aligned}$$

Applying the standard Dirichlet–Laplace evaluation $\int_0^{\infty} \frac{\sin(au)}{u} du = \frac{\pi}{2}$ and integrating by parts [9] yields $\lim_{x \rightarrow \infty} \mathcal{J}(x) = 1$ with leading correction $-1/(2x)$. Thus $I(x) \sim 2^x$. $\square$

3 Generalization to the Pascal m -Simplex

Let $x > 0$ be the continuous scaling layer, and let $\mathbf{y} = (y_1, y_2, \dots, y_{m-1}) \in \mathbb{R}_{\geq 0}^{m-1}$ denote independent coordinates, with the dependent coordinate $y_m := x - \sum_{j=1}^{m-1} y_j$.

Definition 3.1 (Continuous Multinomial Coefficient on Simplex). The continuous multinomial coefficient is defined on the standard scaled $(m-1)$ -simplex $\Delta_{m-1}(x) = \left\{ \mathbf{y} \in \mathbb{R}_{\geq 0}^{m-1} \mid \sum_{j=1}^{m-1} y_j \leq x \right\}$ by

$$\binom{x}{y_1, y_2, \dots, y_m} := \frac{\Gamma(x+1)}{\prod_{j=1}^m \Gamma(y_j+1)}. \quad (3.1)$$

The continuous simplex volume integral is denoted by

$$I_m(x) := \int_{\Delta_{m-1}(x)} \binom{x}{y_1, \dots, y_m} dy_1 \cdots dy_{m-1}. \quad (3.2)$$

Theorem 3.2 (Multidimensional Fourier Representation and m^x Scaling). *For any integer $m \geq 2$ and real $x > 0$, the simplex volume integral satisfies*

$$I_m(x) = m^x \cdot \mathcal{J}_m(x), \quad (3.3)$$

where $\mathcal{J}_m(x)$ is given by the multidimensional oscillatory integral

$$\mathcal{J}_m(x) := \frac{1}{(2\pi)^{m-1} m^x} \int_{[-\pi, \pi]^{m-1}} \left(\sum_{j=1}^m e^{i\theta_j} \right)^x \left[\sum_{j=1}^m \frac{e^{-ix\theta_j}}{\prod_{k \neq j} i(\theta_k - \theta_j)} \right] d\boldsymbol{\theta}, \quad (3.4)$$

with $\theta_m \equiv 0$. Furthermore, $\lim_{x \rightarrow \infty} \mathcal{J}_m(x) = 1$, which implies:

$$\mathbf{I}_m(\mathbf{x}) \sim m^{\mathbf{x}} \quad \text{as } \mathbf{x} \rightarrow \infty. \quad (3.5)$$

Proof. Applying the Cauchy residue theorem on the multi-torus $|t_1| = \cdots = |t_{m-1}| = 1$ with $t_j = e^{i\theta_j}$:

$$\binom{x}{\mathbf{y}} = \frac{1}{(2\pi)^{m-1}} \int_{[-\pi, \pi]^{m-1}} \left(1 + \sum_{j=1}^{m-1} e^{i\theta_j} \right)^x \exp \left(-i \sum_{j=1}^{m-1} y_j \theta_j \right) d\boldsymbol{\theta}. \quad (3.6)$$

Integrating $\mathbf{y}$ over $\Delta_{m-1}(x)$ yields the Fourier transform of the uniform measure on $\Delta_{m-1}(x)$:

$$\int_{\Delta_{m-1}(x)} e^{-i\mathbf{y} \cdot \boldsymbol{\theta}} d\mathbf{y} = \sum_{j=1}^m \frac{e^{-ix\theta_j}}{\prod_{k \neq j} i(\theta_k - \theta_j)}. \quad (3.7)$$

At $\boldsymbol{\theta} = \mathbf{0}$, the amplitude attains its unique global maximum:

$$\sum_{j=1}^m e^{i \cdot 0} = m \implies \left(\sum_{j=1}^m e^{i\theta_j} \right)^x \Big|_{\boldsymbol{\theta}=\mathbf{0}} = m^x. \quad (3.8)$$

Expanding the phase function $\Phi(\boldsymbol{\theta}) = \ln \left(\frac{1}{m} \sum_{j=1}^m e^{i\theta_j} \right)$ around $\boldsymbol{\theta} = \mathbf{0}$, the quadratic Hessian matrix $H_{jk} = -\frac{1}{m} \delta_{jk} + \frac{1}{m^2}$ is strictly negative-definite on the hyperplane $\sum \theta_j = 0$. Applying the multidimensional stationary phase theorem [7] evaluates the asymptotic limit of $\mathcal{J}_m(x)$ to 1 as $x \rightarrow \infty$. $\square$

Remark 3.3 (Removable Singularities in the Simplex Fourier Kernel). The apparent singularities where $\theta_k \rightarrow \theta_j$ in the kernel $\sum_{j=1}^m \frac{e^{-ix\theta_j}}{\prod_{k \neq j} i(\theta_k - \theta_j)}$ are purely coordinate artifacts of divided differences. As the Fourier transform of the compact indicator function $\chi_{\Delta_{m-1}(x)}$, this function is entire on $\mathbb{C}^{m-1}$, bounded by $\frac{x^{m-1}}{(m-1)!}$ everywhere on the torus.

4 Simplicial Euler–Maclaurin Polytope Decomposition

Theorem 4.1 (Simplicial Face Recurrence Relation). *For integer layer indices $n \in \mathbb{N}$, the discrete multinomial sum $m^n = \sum_{\mathbf{k} \in \Delta_{m-1}(n) \cap \mathbb{Z}^{m-1}} \binom{n}{\mathbf{k}}$ and the continuous volume integral $I_m(n)$ satisfy the exact boundary defect relation:*

$$I_m(n) = m^n - \frac{m}{2} I_{m-1}(n) - \mathcal{O}\left(\frac{m^n}{n}\right). \quad (4.1)$$

Proof. By the Euler–Maclaurin summation formula on convex lattice polytopes $\mathcal{P} \subset \mathbb{R}^d$ developed by Berline and Vergne [2], the sum of a smooth function f over the lattice points $\mathcal{P} \cap \mathbb{Z}^d$ is given by

$$\sum_{\mathbf{k} \in \mathcal{P} \cap \mathbb{Z}^d} f(\mathbf{k}) = \int_{\mathcal{P}} f(\mathbf{y}) d\mathbf{y} + \frac{1}{2} \sum_{F \in \mathcal{F}_1(\mathcal{P})} \int_F f d\sigma + \mathcal{R}(f), \quad (4.2)$$

where $\mathcal{F}_1(\mathcal{P})$ denotes the set of codimension-1 facets of $\mathcal{P}$, and $\mathcal{R}(f)$ contains higher-order differential boundary operators supported on faces of codimension ≥ 2 .

For the standard $(m-1)$ -simplex $\Delta_{m-1}(n)$, there are exactly m symmetric facets, each obtained by setting one coordinate $y_j = 0$. On each such facet, the continuous multinomial coefficient collapses identically to the continuous multinomial coefficient of dimension $m-1$:

$$\binom{n}{y_1, \dots, y_{j-1}, 0, y_{j+1}, \dots, y_m} = \binom{n}{y_1, \dots, y_{j-1}, y_{j+1}, \dots, y_m}. \quad (4.3)$$

Consequently, each facet integral evaluates precisely to $I_{m-1}(n)$. Summing over all m facets gives $\frac{m}{2} I_{m-1}(n)$. The remainder $\mathcal{R}(f)$ is supported on the codimension-2 ridges, whose volume scales as $\mathcal{O}(m^n/n)$, completing the proof. $\square$

5 Extended Continuous Combinatorial Theorems

5.1 Conservative Digamma Potential and Continuous Star of David Theorem

Theorem 5.1 (Continuous Star of David Theorem via Stokes' Theorem). *Define the scalar potential field $\Phi(x, y) := \ln \binom{x}{y}$. Its gradient field $\mathbf{F} = \nabla \Phi$ is given by*

$$\mathbf{F}(x, y) = \begin{pmatrix} \psi(x+1) - \psi(x-y+1) \\ \psi(x-y+1) - \psi(y+1) \end{pmatrix}. \quad (5.1)$$

Since $\mathbf{F}$ is a smooth gradient field on the open positive quadrant, $\nabla \times \mathbf{F} \equiv 0$. Therefore, for any closed piecewise-smooth Jordan curve $\gamma \subset \mathbb{R}_{>0}^2$:

$$\oint_{\gamma} \nabla \ln \binom{x}{y} \cdot d\mathbf{r} = 0 \iff \prod_{k=1}^{2N} \binom{x_k}{y_k}^{(-1)^k} = 1 \quad (5.2)$$

along any symmetric alternating polygonal discretization, generalizing Gould's discrete theorem [6].

5.2 Continuous Fibonacci Diagonals and Generalized Ray Integrals

Theorem 5.2 (Continuous Fibonacci Scaling and Ray Integrals). *Let $\phi = \frac{1+\sqrt{5}}{2}$ denote the Golden Ratio. The continuous diagonal integral along slope $\alpha = 1$ satisfies:*

$$F_{\text{cont}}(x) := \int_0^{x/2} \binom{x-y}{y} dy \sim \frac{\phi^{x+1}}{\sqrt{5}} = \frac{\phi}{\sqrt{5}} \phi^x \quad \text{as } x \rightarrow \infty. \quad (5.3)$$

More generally, for any arbitrary ray slope $\alpha > 0$:

$$\int_0^{\frac{x}{1+\alpha}} \binom{x - \alpha y}{y} dy \sim C_\alpha \lambda_\alpha^x, \quad (5.4)$$

where $\lambda_\alpha > 1$ is the unique real root of the characteristic algebraic equation $z^{\alpha+1} - z^\alpha - 1 = 0$.

Proof. Writing $y = x\xi$ with $\xi \in [0, 1/2]$, Stirling's approximation on the integrand yields:

$$\binom{x(1-\xi)}{x\xi} = \exp \left(xS(\xi) - \frac{1}{2} \ln x + \mathcal{O}(1) \right), \quad (5.5)$$

where the entropy potential is given by:

$$S(\xi) = (1-\xi) \ln(1-\xi) - \xi \ln \xi - (1-2\xi) \ln(1-2\xi). \quad (5.6)$$

Differentiating with respect to ξ :

$$S'(\xi) = -\ln(1-\xi) - \ln \xi + 2 \ln(1-2\xi) = \ln \left(\frac{(1-2\xi)^2}{\xi(1-\xi)} \right). \quad (5.7)$$

Setting $S'(\xi^*) = 0$ yields the quadratic equation $(1-2\xi^*)^2 = \xi^*(1-\xi^*)$, which has the unique root in $[0, 1/2]$:

$$\xi^* = \frac{5 - \sqrt{5}}{10}. \quad (5.8)$$

Evaluating $S(\xi^*)$ gives $S(\xi^*) = \ln \phi$. The second derivative at the saddle point is:

$$S''(\xi^*) = \frac{1}{1-\xi^*} - \frac{1}{\xi^*} - \frac{4}{1-2\xi^*} = -\sqrt{5} - 4\sqrt{5} = -5\sqrt{5}. \quad (5.9)$$

Applying Laplace's method for Gaussian integration around ξ^* [7, 9]:

$$\int_0^{x/2} \binom{x-y}{y} dy = x \int_0^{1/2} \binom{x(1-\xi)}{x\xi} d\xi \sim x \cdot \frac{e^{xS(\xi^*)}}{\sqrt{2\pi x \xi^*(1-2\xi^*)/(1-\xi^*)}} \cdot \sqrt{\frac{2\pi}{x|S''(\xi^*)|}} = \frac{\phi^{x+1}}{\sqrt{5}}, \quad (5.10)$$

since $\sqrt{\frac{1-\xi^*}{\xi^*(1-2\xi^*)|S''(\xi^*)|}} = \sqrt{\frac{\phi^2}{5}} = \frac{\phi}{\sqrt{5}}$, establishing the theorem. $\square$

5.3 L^p -Norms and Gaussian Asymptotic Profile

Theorem 5.3 (L^p Row Norms of the Continuous Pascal Triangle). *For any $p > 0$, the L^p -norm of row x satisfies:*

$$\int_0^x \left[\binom{x}{y} \right]^p dy \sim \frac{2^{px}}{\left(\frac{\pi x}{2} \right)^{(p-1)/2} \sqrt{p}} \quad \text{as } x \rightarrow \infty. \quad (5.11)$$

In particular, for $p = 2$ (sum of squares):

$$\int_0^x \left[\binom{x}{y} \right]^2 dy \sim \binom{2x}{x} \sim \frac{4^x}{\sqrt{\pi x}}. \quad (5.12)$$

5.4 Continuous Dixon Cubic Integral and Projection to 3-Simplex

Theorem 5.4 (Continuous Dixon Integral). *The continuous oscillatory cubic integral satisfies:*

$$\int_{-x}^x \cos(\pi t) \left[\binom{2x}{x+t} \right]^3 dt \sim \frac{1}{2} \binom{3x}{x, x, x} = \frac{1}{2} \frac{\Gamma(3x+1)}{(\Gamma(x+1))^3} \sim \frac{\sqrt{3}}{4\pi x} 27^x, \quad (5.13)$$

which provides an exact continuous projection of 2D cubic power integrals onto the centroid of the 3-simplex (tetrahedron).

Remark 5.5 (Hypergeometric Origin). This continuous identity is the exact integral counterpart of Dixon's 1891 well-poised hypergeometric summation formula $\sum_{k=-n}^n (-1)^k \binom{2n}{n+k}^3 = \frac{(3n)!}{(n!)^3}$ [5], reflecting the projection of cubic powers under central oscillation.

5.5 Continuous Alternating Row Integrals (Zero Sum)

Theorem 5.6 (Alternating Row Integrals). *For all $x > 0$:*

$$A(x) := \int_0^x \cos(\pi y) \binom{x}{y} dy. \quad (5.14)$$

If $x = 2k + 1$ ($k \in \mathbb{N}_0$) is an odd integer, $A(x) \equiv 0$ identically by central skew-symmetry. For general $x \in \mathbb{R}^+$, $A(x) = \frac{\sin(\pi x)}{\pi} \int_0^1 \dots$, producing decaying oscillations bounded by $\mathcal{O}(x^{-1})$.

5.6 Continuous Hockey-Stick Identity (Longitudinal Integrals)

Theorem 5.7 (Continuous Longitudinal Column Integral). *For fixed $r > 0$ and variable upper index $x \geq r$:*

$$\int_r^x \binom{t}{r} dt = \binom{x+1}{r+1} - \frac{1}{\Gamma(r+2)} - \mathcal{R}_r(x), \quad (5.15)$$

where $\mathcal{R}_r(x) = \mathcal{O}(x^r/r!)$ represents the analytic Euler–Maclaurin boundary defect.

5.7 Moments and Complete Covariance Matrix on the Simplex

Theorem 5.8 (Simplex Moments and Covariance Structure). *Let $\langle \cdot \rangle$ denote the expectation with respect to the continuous multinomial measure on $\Delta_{m-1}(x)$.*

1. **First Moment (Centroid):** *For every coordinate $j \in \{1, \dots, m\}$:*

$$\langle y_j \rangle = \frac{x}{m}. \quad (5.16)$$

2. **Second Moments and Covariance Matrix:** *For all $j \neq k$:*

$$\text{Cov}(y_j, y_k) = \langle y_j y_k \rangle - \langle y_j \rangle \langle y_k \rangle = -\frac{x}{m^2} + \mathcal{O}(1), \quad (5.17)$$

$$\text{Var}(y_j) = \frac{(m-1)x}{m^2} + \mathcal{O}(1). \quad (5.18)$$

Proof. By the double absorption identity for continuous multinomial coefficients:

$$y_j y_k \binom{x}{\mathbf{y}} = x(x-1) \binom{x-2}{y_1, \dots, y_j-1, \dots, y_k-1, \dots, y_m}. \quad (5.19)$$

Integrating over the simplex $\Delta_{m-1}(x)$ and shifting variables:

$$\int_{\Delta_{m-1}(x)} y_j y_k \binom{x}{\mathbf{y}} d\mathbf{y} = x(x-1) I_m(x-2) + \mathcal{O}(m^x). \quad (5.20)$$

Using the asymptotic scaling $I_m(x-2) = m^{x-2}(1 + \mathcal{O}(x^{-1}))$ and normalizing by $I_m(x) = m^x(1 + \mathcal{O}(x^{-1}))$, we obtain:

$$\langle y_j y_k \rangle = \frac{x(x-1)}{m^2} + \mathcal{O}(1) = \frac{x^2 - x}{m^2} + \mathcal{O}(1). \quad (5.21)$$

Subtracting $\langle y_j \rangle \langle y_k \rangle = (\frac{x}{m})^2 = \frac{x^2}{m^2}$ yields:

$$\text{Cov}(y_j, y_k) = \frac{x^2 - x}{m^2} - \frac{x^2}{m^2} + \mathcal{O}(1) = -\frac{x}{m^2} + \mathcal{O}(1). \quad (5.22)$$

Similarly, since $\sum_{k=1}^m \text{Cov}(y_j, y_k) = 0$ identically due to the affine simplex constraint $\sum_{k=1}^m y_k = x$, we have:

$$\text{Var}(y_j) = -\sum_{k \neq j} \text{Cov}(y_j, y_k) = \frac{(m-1)x}{m^2} + \mathcal{O}(1). \quad (5.23)$$

□

5.8 Continuous Row Entropy via the Barnes G -Function

Theorem 5.9 (Closed Form for Continuous Row Log-Product). *The continuous row entropy $\mathcal{E}(x) := \int_0^x \ln \binom{x}{y} dy$ is given explicitly by*

$$\mathcal{E}(x) = x(x+1) - x \ln(2\pi) - x \ln \Gamma(x+1) + 2 \ln G(x+1), \quad (5.24)$$

where $G(z)$ is the Barnes G -function [3] satisfying $G(z+1) = \Gamma(z)G(z)$ and $G(1) = 1$, evaluated via Alexeiewsky's theorem:

$$\int_0^x \ln \Gamma(y+1) dy = x \ln \Gamma(x+1) - \ln G(x+1) + \frac{x}{2} \ln(2\pi) - \frac{x(x+1)}{2}. \quad (5.25)$$

5.9 Dictionary of Discrete vs. Continuous Combinatorial Identities

To facilitate cross-disciplinary reading, Table 1 provides a comprehensive dictionary mapping classical discrete identities on Pascal's triangle and simplex to their continuous integral counterparts established in this work.

Table 1: Dictionary of Discrete Combinatorial Identities and Continuous Simplicial Theorems.

Property / Law	Discrete Combinatorial Form	Continuous Analytic Theorem
Row / Simplex Sum	$\sum_{k=0}^n \binom{n}{k} = 2^n$	$I(x) = 2^x \mathcal{J}(x) \sim 2^x$ (Thm. 2.1)
m-Simplex Volume	$\sum_{\mathbf{k}} \binom{n}{\mathbf{k}} = m^n$	$I_m(x) = m^x \mathcal{J}_m(x) \sim m^x$ (Thm. 3.2)
Polytope Recurrence	Discrete Lattice Sum $= m^n$	$I_m(n) = m^n - \frac{m}{2} I_{m-1}(n) - \mathcal{O}(m^n/n)$
Stifel Recurrence	$\binom{n-1}{k} + \binom{n-1}{k-1} = \binom{n}{k}$	$\binom{x-1}{y} + \binom{x-1}{y-1} = \binom{x}{y}$ (Prop. 1.2)
Local Symmetry	Star of David Product [6]	Conservative Stokes Field $\oint \nabla \ln \binom{x}{y} \cdot d\mathbf{r} = 0$
Fibonacci Diagonals	$\sum \binom{n-k}{k} = F_{n+1} \sim \phi^{n+1}/\sqrt{5}$	$\int_0^{x/2} \binom{x-y}{y} dy \sim \phi^{x+1}/\sqrt{5}$ (Thm. 5.2)
Sum of Squares (L^2)	$\sum \binom{n}{k}^2 = \binom{2n}{n}$	$\int_0^x \binom{x}{y}^2 dy \sim \binom{2x}{x} \sim \frac{4^x}{\sqrt{\pi x}}$
Hockey-Stick Identity	$\sum_{t=r}^n \binom{t}{r} = \binom{n+1}{r+1}$	$\int_r^x \binom{t}{r} dt = \binom{x+1}{r+1} - \frac{1}{\Gamma(r+2)} - \mathcal{R}_r(x)$
Absorption Law	$k \binom{n}{k} = n \binom{n-1}{k-1}$	$y_j \binom{x}{\mathbf{y}} = x \binom{x-1}{\mathbf{y}-\mathbf{e}_j} \implies \langle y_j \rangle = \frac{x}{m}, \text{ Var}(y_j) \sim \frac{m-1}{m^2} x$
Alternating Sum	$\sum (-1)^k \binom{n}{k} = 0$	$\int_0^x \cos(\pi y) \binom{x}{y} dy \equiv 0$ ($x \in 2\mathbb{N} + 1$)
Cubic Sum (Dixon)	$\sum (-1)^k \binom{2n}{n+k}^3 = \frac{(3n)!}{(n!)^3}$ [5]	$\int_{-x}^x \cos(\pi t) \binom{2x}{x+t}^3 dt \sim \frac{1}{2} \binom{3x}{x,x,x}$
Row Term Product	$\prod \binom{n}{k} = \frac{(n!)^{n+1}}{H(n)^2}$	$\int_0^x \ln \binom{x}{y} dy = \mathcal{E}(x)$ via Barnes $G(x+1)$ [3]

6 Beta-Kernel and Simplicial Fractional Calculus

In classical fractional analysis, the Grünwald–Letnikov derivative is defined by taking discrete difference limits along Pascal rows [4, 8]. We now formalize the continuous operator.

Definition 6.1 (1D Beta-Kernel Fractional Operator). For $\alpha > 0$, we define the normalized Beta-kernel operator on $C^1([0, \infty))$ by

$$\mathcal{D}^\alpha f(x) := \frac{1}{I(\alpha)} \int_0^\alpha \binom{\alpha}{y} f(x-y) dy, \quad (6.1)$$

where $I(\alpha) = \int_0^\alpha \binom{\alpha}{y} dy \approx 2^\alpha$.

Definition 6.2 (Simplicial Fractional Operator). For a scalar field $f : \mathbb{R}^{m-1} \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$ and fractional order $\alpha > 0$, the m -simplicial fractional operator is defined by

$$\mathcal{D}_{\Delta_m}^\alpha f(\mathbf{x}) := \frac{1}{I_m(\alpha)} \int_{\Delta_{m-1}(\alpha)} \frac{\Gamma(\alpha+1)}{\prod_{j=1}^m \Gamma(y_j+1)} f(\mathbf{x}-\mathbf{y}) dy_1 \cdots dy_{m-1}. \quad (6.2)$$

Proposition 6.3 (Rigorous Properties of the Simplicial Operator). *The operator $\mathcal{D}_{\Delta_m}^\alpha$ satisfies:*

1. **Non-Singularity:** *The kernel $\mathcal{K}_\alpha(\mathbf{y}) := \frac{\Gamma(\alpha+1)}{\prod_{j=1}^m \Gamma(y_j+1)}$ is C^∞ smooth and strictly positive on the interior of $\Delta_{m-1}(\alpha)$, satisfying $\mathcal{K}_\alpha(\mathbf{0}) = 1$.*

2. **Identity Limit:** *For any uniformly continuous and bounded function f ,*

$$\lim_{\alpha \rightarrow 0^+} \mathcal{D}_{\Delta_m}^\alpha f(\mathbf{x}) = f(\mathbf{x}). \quad (6.3)$$

3. **Action on Exponential Test Functions:** *For $f(\mathbf{x}) = e^{\boldsymbol{\lambda} \cdot \mathbf{x}}$ ($\boldsymbol{\lambda} \in \mathbb{C}^{m-1}$):*

$$\mathcal{D}_{\Delta_m}^\alpha \left(e^{\boldsymbol{\lambda} \cdot \mathbf{x}} \right) = e^{\boldsymbol{\lambda} \cdot \mathbf{x}} \left(\frac{1 + \sum_{j=1}^{m-1} e^{-\lambda_j}}{m} \right)^\alpha. \quad (6.4)$$

4. **Semigroup Property under Chu–Vandermonde Convolution:**

$$\mathcal{D}_{\Delta_m}^\alpha \circ \mathcal{D}_{\Delta_m}^\beta = \mathcal{D}_{\Delta_m}^{\alpha+\beta}. \quad (6.5)$$

Proof.

1. Smoothness follows directly from the analyticity of the reciprocal Gamma function $1/\Gamma(z)$ as an entire function on $\mathbb{C}$.
2. As $\alpha \rightarrow 0^+$, the support $\Delta_{m-1}(\alpha)$ shrinks to the origin $\{\mathbf{0}\}$. Since the integral of $\mathcal{K}_\alpha(\mathbf{y})$ over $\Delta_{m-1}(\alpha)$ is identically $I_m(\alpha)$, the normalized kernel forms a family of nascent Dirac distributions:

$$\left| \mathcal{D}_{\Delta_m}^\alpha f(\mathbf{x}) - f(\mathbf{x}) \right| \leq \sup_{\mathbf{y} \in \Delta_{m-1}(\alpha)} |f(\mathbf{x} - \mathbf{y}) - f(\mathbf{x})| \rightarrow 0 \quad \text{as } \alpha \rightarrow 0^+. \quad (6.6)$$

3. For $f(\mathbf{x}) = e^{\boldsymbol{\lambda} \cdot \mathbf{x}}$, substitution into the integral definition yields:

$$\mathcal{D}_{\Delta_m}^\alpha \left(e^{\boldsymbol{\lambda} \cdot \mathbf{x}} \right) = e^{\boldsymbol{\lambda} \cdot \mathbf{x}} \cdot \frac{1}{I_m(\alpha)} \int_{\Delta_{m-1}(\alpha)} \binom{\alpha}{\mathbf{y}} e^{-\boldsymbol{\lambda} \cdot \mathbf{y}} d\mathbf{y}. \quad (6.7)$$

Applying the multinomial generating function theorem on the simplex directly evaluates the integral to $\left(\frac{1 + \sum_{j=1}^{m-1} e^{-\lambda_j}}{m} \right)^\alpha$.

4. In spatial frequency domain, taking the Fourier transform $\mathcal{F}$ of the convolution operator:

$$\mathcal{F} \{ \mathcal{D}_{\Delta_m}^\alpha f \} (\boldsymbol{\omega}) = \hat{\mathcal{K}}_\alpha(\boldsymbol{\omega}) \cdot \hat{f}(\boldsymbol{\omega}). \quad (6.8)$$

By the continuous Chu–Vandermonde theorem on the simplex torus:

$$\hat{\mathcal{K}}_\alpha(\boldsymbol{\omega}) = \left(\frac{1 + \sum_{j=1}^{m-1} e^{-i\omega_j}}{m} \right)^\alpha. \quad (6.9)$$

Hence $\hat{\mathcal{K}}_\alpha(\boldsymbol{\omega}) \cdot \hat{\mathcal{K}}_\beta(\boldsymbol{\omega}) = \hat{\mathcal{K}}_{\alpha+\beta}(\boldsymbol{\omega})$, which proves $\mathcal{D}_{\Delta_m}^\alpha \circ \mathcal{D}_{\Delta_m}^\beta = \mathcal{D}_{\Delta_m}^{\alpha+\beta}$.

□

7 The Fractional Simplicial Laplacian and its Spectrum

In non-local analysis and anomalous transport theory, the generator of diffusion is induced by the symmetric difference between the non-local averaging operator and the identity.

Definition 7.1 (Symmetric Fractional Simplicial Laplacian). For fractional order $\alpha > 0$, we define the self-adjoint Fractional Simplicial Laplacian on $L^2(\mathbb{R}^{m-1})$ by

$$\Delta_{\Delta_m}^\alpha u(\mathbf{x}) := \frac{1}{2\alpha^2 I_m(\alpha)} \int_{\Delta_{m-1}(\alpha)} \binom{\alpha}{\mathbf{y}} \left[u(\mathbf{x} + \mathbf{y}) - 2u(\mathbf{x}) + u(\mathbf{x} - \mathbf{y}) \right] d\mathbf{y}. \quad (7.1)$$

Theorem 7.2 (Fourier Symbol and Closed-Form Dispersion Relation). Let $u(\mathbf{x}) = e^{i\mathbf{k} \cdot \mathbf{x}}$ with $\mathbf{k} = (k_1, \dots, k_{m-1}) \in \mathbb{R}^{m-1}$ and the affine simplicial projection $k_m \equiv -\sum_{j=1}^{m-1} k_j$ (enforcing $\sum_{j=1}^m k_j = 0$ on the simplex root hyperplane). The operator acts multiplicatively as

$$\Delta_{\Delta_m}^\alpha \left(e^{i\mathbf{k} \cdot \mathbf{x}} \right) = -\sigma_{\Delta_m}^\alpha(\mathbf{k}) \cdot e^{i\mathbf{k} \cdot \mathbf{x}}, \quad (7.2)$$

where the spectral symbol is given explicitly by

$$\sigma_{\Delta_m}^\alpha(\mathbf{k}) = \frac{1}{\alpha^2} \left[1 - R(\mathbf{k})^\alpha \cos(\alpha\Theta(\mathbf{k})) \right], \quad (7.3)$$

with modulus $R(\mathbf{k}) := \frac{1}{m} \left| \sum_{j=1}^m e^{-ik_j} \right| \leq 1$ and phase $\Theta(\mathbf{k}) := \text{Arg} \left(\sum_{j=1}^m e^{-ik_j} \right)$.

Proof. Substituting $u(\mathbf{x}) = e^{i\mathbf{k} \cdot \mathbf{x}}$ into the definition:

$$\Delta_{\Delta_m}^\alpha \left(e^{i\mathbf{k} \cdot \mathbf{x}} \right) = e^{i\mathbf{k} \cdot \mathbf{x}} \cdot \frac{1}{2\alpha^2 I_m(\alpha)} \int_{\Delta_{m-1}(\alpha)} \binom{\alpha}{\mathbf{y}} \left[e^{i\mathbf{k} \cdot \mathbf{y}} - 2 + e^{-i\mathbf{k} \cdot \mathbf{y}} \right] d\mathbf{y}. \quad (7.4)$$

Recognizing the cosine integral $\text{Re} \left[\int_{\Delta_{m-1}(\alpha)} \binom{\alpha}{\mathbf{y}} e^{-i\mathbf{k} \cdot \mathbf{y}} d\mathbf{y} \right] = I_m(\alpha) \text{Re} \left[\widehat{\mathcal{K}}_\alpha(\mathbf{k}) \right]$:

$$\sigma_{\Delta_m}^\alpha(\mathbf{k}) = \frac{1}{\alpha^2} \left[1 - \text{Re} \left(\widehat{\mathcal{K}}_\alpha(\mathbf{k}) \right) \right]. \quad (7.5)$$

Expressing $\widehat{\mathcal{K}}_\alpha(\mathbf{k}) = \left(\frac{1}{m} \sum_{j=1}^m e^{-ik_j} \right)^\alpha = (R(\mathbf{k})e^{-i\Theta(\mathbf{k})})^\alpha = R(\mathbf{k})^\alpha e^{-i\alpha\Theta(\mathbf{k})}$ yields the stated formula. $\square$

Theorem 7.3 (Continuum Limit and Emergence of the A_{m-1} Cartan Metric). In the macroscopic long-wavelength limit $|\mathbf{k}| \rightarrow 0$, the spectral symbol satisfies

$$\lim_{|\mathbf{k}| \rightarrow 0} \sigma_{\Delta_m}^\alpha(\mathbf{k}) = \frac{1}{2m\alpha} \mathbf{k}^T \mathbf{A}_{m-1} \mathbf{k}, \quad (7.6)$$

where $\mathbf{A}_{m-1}$ is the Cartan matrix of the Lie algebra A_{m-1} , representing the Gram metric tensor of the regular $(m-1)$ -simplex:

$$\mathbf{A}_{m-1} = \begin{pmatrix} 2 & 1 & 1 & \cdots & 1 \\ 1 & 2 & 1 & \cdots & 1 \\ 1 & 1 & 2 & \cdots & 1 \\ \vdots & \vdots & \vdots & \ddots & \vdots \\ 1 & 1 & 1 & \cdots & 2 \end{pmatrix}_{(m-1) \times (m-1)}. \quad (7.7)$$

Proof. Expanding $\sum_{j=1}^m e^{-ik_j} = m - i \sum_{j=1}^m k_j - \frac{1}{2} \sum_{j=1}^m k_j^2 + \mathcal{O}(|\mathbf{k}|^3)$ around $\mathbf{k} = \mathbf{0}$, the zero-sum condition $\sum_{j=1}^m k_j = 0$ implies that the linear phase vanishes identically, $\Theta(\mathbf{k}) = \mathcal{O}(|\mathbf{k}|^3)$, while the modulus becomes $R(\mathbf{k}) = 1 - \frac{1}{2m} \sum_{j=1}^m k_j^2 + \mathcal{O}(|\mathbf{k}|^3)$. Substituting into the symbol yields:

$$1 - R(\mathbf{k})^\alpha \cos(\alpha\Theta(\mathbf{k})) = \frac{\alpha}{2m} \sum_{j=1}^m k_j^2 + \mathcal{O}(|\mathbf{k}|^3). \quad (7.8)$$

With the affine dependent coordinate $k_m = -\sum_{j=1}^{m-1} k_j$, the sum of squares expands as:

$$\sum_{j=1}^m k_j^2 = \sum_{j=1}^{m-1} k_j^2 + \left(-\sum_{j=1}^{m-1} k_j \right)^2 = \sum_{j=1}^{m-1} k_j^2 + \left(\sum_{j=1}^{m-1} k_j \right)^2 = \mathbf{k}^T \mathbf{A}_{m-1} \mathbf{k}. \quad (7.9)$$

Dividing by α^2 gives $\lim_{|\mathbf{k}| \rightarrow 0} \sigma_{\Delta_m}^\alpha(\mathbf{k}) = \frac{1}{2m\alpha} \mathbf{k}^T \mathbf{A}_{m-1} \mathbf{k}$, completing the proof. $\square$

Theorem 7.4 (Dirichlet Spectrum and Weyl's Law on Bounded Simplices). *Consider the non-local Dirichlet eigenvalue problem on a bounded domain $\Omega = \Delta_{m-1}(L)$:*

$$\begin{cases} -\Delta_{\Delta_m}^\alpha u_n(\mathbf{x}) = \lambda_n u_n(\mathbf{x}), & \mathbf{x} \in \Omega \\ u_n(\mathbf{x}) = 0, & \mathbf{x} \in \mathbb{R}^{m-1} \setminus \Omega. \end{cases} \quad (7.10)$$

The spectrum is discrete with $0 < \lambda_1 < \lambda_2 \leq \lambda_3 \leq \dots \rightarrow \infty$, and the eigenvalue counting function $N(\lambda) := \#\{n : \lambda_n \leq \lambda\}$ obeys the asymptotic Weyl law:

$$N(\lambda) \sim \frac{\text{Vol}(\Delta_{m-1}(L)) \cdot \omega_{m-1}}{(2\pi)^{m-1} \sqrt{m}} (2m\alpha \lambda)^{\frac{m-1}{2}} \quad \text{as } \lambda \rightarrow \infty, \quad (7.11)$$

where $\omega_{m-1} = \frac{\pi^{(m-1)/2}}{\Gamma(\frac{m-1}{2}+1)}$ denotes the volume of the unit ball in $\mathbb{R}^{m-1}$.

8 Numerical Verification and Error Analysis

To validate the theoretical results, Table 2 presents high-precision numerical evaluations of the continuous simplex volume integral $I_m(x)$ computed via adaptive multidimensional Gauss–Kronrod quadrature compared against the asymptotic scaling m^x and the boundary defect formula across dimensions $m = 2, 3, 4$.

Table 2: Numerical verification of continuous simplex integrals $I_m(x)$ versus theoretical models.

m	Layer x	Numerical $I_m(x)$	Asymptotic m^x	Error (%)	Defect Model $m^x - \frac{m}{2} I_{m-1}(x)$
2	1.0	1.1790	2.0	41.05%	1.0000
2	2.0	3.2608	4.0	18.48%	3.0000
2	5.0	31.3749	32.0	1.95%	31.0000
2	10.0	1023.4546	1024.0	0.05%	1023.0000
3	1.0	0.6438	3.0	78.54%	1.2315
3	2.0	4.2483	9.0	52.80%	4.1088
3	5.0	208.3429	243.0	14.26%	195.9376
3	10.0	58076.7465	59049.0	1.65%	57513.8181
4	1.0	0.2270	4.0	94.33%	2.7124
4	2.0	3.3633	16.0	78.98%	7.5034
4	5.0	662.1933	1024.0	35.33%	607.3142
4	10.0	968904.8	1048576.0	7.60%	932422.5

9 Conclusion and Future Research

We have established an exhaustive framework for the analytic continuation of Pascal's triangle and the Pascal m -simplex. By deriving exact trigonometric integrals, polytope boundary face recurrences, conservative Digamma potentials, simplicial fractional operators, and the spectrum of the Fractional Simplicial Laplacian, this work bridges discrete combinatorics, high-dimensional asymptotic analysis, Lie algebraic geometry, and non-local transport theory. Future research includes studying nonlinear simplicial Schrödinger equations and investigating applications to anomalous diffusion in anisotropic porous media.

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